

Digital Forensic Examination Report

NIST/CFReDS Hacking Case Schardt / "Mr. Evil"

Case ID: CIP-B104-CS1-C11_26_DFIT_17305

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Registration number: C11/26/DFIT/17305

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Evidence item(s) examined: SCHARDT.001–
SCHARDT.008 (8 raw image segments), reconstructed as
SCHARDT.dd

Acquisition tool / hash values: wget (download), cat
(reconstruction), md5sum / sha256sum (verification) see

Section: 1

Executive Summary

This examination analysed a raw disk image (SCHARDT.001–008) recovered from a Dell CPi notebook believed to be associated with an individual using the name "Greg Schardt" and the online alias "Mr. Evil." The image contains a Windows XP installation registered to Greg Schardt, with a primary local account named "Mr. Evil" that was the most-used and last-used account on the system. Registry, configuration, browser-cache and application artefacts consistently link the "Mr. Evil" profile to the Greg Schardt identity. The system had several dual-use network and security tools installed including Ethereal, WinPcap, Network Stumbler, Cain & Abel, Anonymizer Bar, and CuteFTP several of which were installed and then their installers deleted to the Recycle Bin within the same session. A recovered packet-capture file ("interception") on the Mr. Evil profile contains intercepted HTTP traffic from a Windows CE (Pocket PC) device visiting Microsoft Passport login pages, consistent with the allegation of traffic interception. Deleted-file and antivirus analysis further corroborate hacking-tool installation and use. Overall, the evidence is assessed as strongly supporting the hypothesis that this computer was operated by Greg Schardt under the alias Mr. Evil and was used to install and operate network-interception and password-recovery tools; see Section: 8.3 for the calibrated final conclusion.

1. Case Preparation & Evidence Integrity

1.1 Evidence Inventory

S/N	Filename	Description	Hash (MD5)	Hash (sha256)
1	SCHARD T.001	Raw image segment 1/8	28a9b613d6eefe8a05 15ef0a675bdebd	358c23312927693a916d0d514e3b44afd45d9358f0622a a0dac7e1e1008a8f0c
2	SCHARD T.002	Raw image segment 2/8	c7227e7eea82d21866 3257397679a7c4	bef9f7fd39abc1f8e52c7b532b552c7f36c8e5ae8ffb2269 5cfac3d7a621a292
3	SCHARD T.003	Raw image segment 3/8	ebba35acd7b8aa85a5 a7c13f3dd733d2	37238e7067145ff3c4b2686bd87d6b14d86f0114af4df13 66cb726c84d673b4e
4	SCHARD T.004	Raw image segment 4/8	669b6636dcb4783fd5 509c4710856c59	b665818259fe34789bae514bd182940c745d73e83527ff b04abac32631d949d3
5	SCHARD T.005	Raw image segment 5/8	c46e5760e3821522ee 81e675422025bb	d7f5109fb7ae257945ae69952f5751e49cbe8f920f08cef2 4b1f0b1e362227fd
6	SCHARD T.006	Raw image segment 6/8	99511901da2dea772 005b5d0d764e750	bcd15a7a7c0522600afee9c83c298072ed9ce2b5a03a462 0c21c2b016005148f

7	SCHARD T.007	Raw image segment 7/8	99511901da2dea772 005b5d0d764e750	bcd15a7a7c0522600afee9c83c298072ed9ce2b5a03a462 0c21c2b016005148f
8	SCHARD T.008	Raw image segment 8/8	8194a79a5356df7988 3ae2dc7415929f	7a944d162497d5abbbd01899106ebee724cee23b4e8c59 e536437b2656d59774

The MD5 values for SCHARDT.006 and SCHARDT.007 are identical. This is recorded as an evidence-integrity anomaly and should be verified against the working copy of the evidence before the examination is finalized.

1.2 Reconstruction & Hash Verification

Reconstruction command: `cat SCHARDT.00* > SCHARDT.dd`

Hash Type	Published / Historical Value	Calculated Value	Match?
MD5	ae4fcd9301c03b3b054623ca261959a	ae4fcd9301c03b3b054623ca261959a	Yes

Mismatch notes: No mismatch is recorded for the published MD5 value.

2. Disk & File-System Examination

Property	Value
Image type	Raw (dd-style) disk image
Partition table type	DOS Partition Table
NTFS partition start (validated offset)	Sector 63 (0000000063)
Partition length	9,510,417 sectors ($\approx$ 4.53 GiB at 512 bytes/sector)
Unallocated regions noted	Sectors 0–62 (pre-partition); sectors 9,510,480–9,514,259 (post-partition, 3,780 sectors)
Total files (allocated)	
Total deleted entries (file-system level)	365 (fls -rFd -o 63 SCHARDT.dd wc -l)

3. Windows System & Registry Profile

3.1 Extracted Hives / Logs

Artefact	Source Path (inode, this image)
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SOFTWARE hive	WINDOWS/system32/config/software (inode 336)
SYSTEM hive	WINDOWS/system32/config/system (inode 334)
SAM hive	WINDOWS/system32/config/SAM (inode 3667)
System event log	WINDOWS/system32/config/SysEvent.Evt (inode 3678)

3.2 System Profile Table

Field	Value (original)	Value (UTC)
Operating system / build	Microsoft Windows XP, build 2600.xpclient.010817-1148	
Install date	2004-08-19 22:48:27Z	2004-08-19 22:48:27 UTC
Timezone setting	Central Standard/Daylight Time (Bias 360 / 6h, ActiveTimeBias 300 / 5h)	
Registered owner	Greg Schardt	
Computer name	N-1A9ODN6ZXK4LQ	
Workgroup / domain	EVIL (Workgroup)	
Last shutdown time	2004-08-27 15:46:33Z	2004-08-27 15:46:33 UTC

3.3 Local Accounts (SAM samparse)

Username	RID	Created (UTC)	Last Login (UTC)	Login Count	Notes
Administrator	500	2004-08-19 16:59:24Z	Never	0	Default admin account

Guest	501	2004-08-19 16:59:24Z	Never	0	Disabled by default; password not required
HelpAssistant	1000	2004-08-19 22:28:24Z	Never	0	Remote Assistance built-in acct
SUPPORT_388945a0	1002	2004-08-19 22:35:19Z	Never	0	Microsoft vendor support account
Mr. Evil	1003	2004-08-19 23:03:54Z	2004-08-27 15:08:23Z	15	Primary/most-used account; Default Admin User type

3.4 Last Logged-On User

The "Mr. Evil" account (RID 1003) was the most frequently used local account, with 15 recorded logins. It was also the last account to log on before the final recorded system shutdown.

This finding is supported by the SAM timeline, which records the last login for Mr. Evil at 2004-08-27 15:08:23 UTC. The ProfileList entry for the Mr. Evil profile was last written at 15:46:23 UTC, approximately ten seconds before the recorded shutdown at 15:46:33 UTC. The timestamps are consistent with the profile being unloaded as the session ended.

4. Suspect Attribution

The following evidence connects the Greg Schardt identity, the Mr. Evil account, the user profile and the examined computer.

Evidence Type	Artefact / Source	Links To	Strength
Registered owner (registry)	SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows NT\CurrentVersion, RegisteredOwner value	Greg Schardt	Moderate (self-reported at install)

User profile path	Documents and Settings\Mr. Evil\...	Mr. Evil account	Strong (system-generated)
Look@LAN config (irunin.ini)	%REGOWNER%=Greg Schardt, %USERNAME%=Greg Schardt, %LANUSER%=Mr. Evil, paths under \Mr. Evil\	Greg Schardt ↔ Mr. Evil	Strong (same install session ties both names to one profile)
Look@LAN setup log	WINDOWS/Look@LAN Setup Log.txt shortcuts placed on Mr. Evil's Desktop	Mr. Evil	Moderate
Browser history co-occurrence	index.dat, Mr. Evil profile: edit.yahoo.com/config/id_check?fn=Greg&ln=Schardt&id=mrevil2000	Greg Schardt + Mr. Evil, same session	Strong (direct identity linkage)
Webmail identity	mrevilrulez@yahoo.com — most frequent address in Mr. Evil's profile (12 occurrences)	Mr. Evil	Strong
NNTP / email identity	Forte Agent AGENT.INI — FullName="Mr Evil", EmailAddress=whoknowsme@sbcglobal.net	Mr. Evil	Moderate
IRC nickname	mIRC mirc.ini userid=Mrevil	Mr. Evil	Moderate

4.1 Network Adapters

Adapter Description	MAC Address	Vendor (OUI lookup)	Associated With Look@LAN Setup?
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Xircom CardBus Ethernet 100 + Modem 56	0010a4933e09	Xircom	Yes %LANNIC%=0010a4933e09 in irunin.ini matches this adapter's MAC/OUI
Compaq WL110 Wireless LAN PC Card			Not confirmed registered later (2004-08-27), after Look@LAN setup (2004-08- 25); wireless card is the one referenced in the case scenario for wardriving

4.2 Attribution Confidence & Alternative Explanations

The attribution assessment is moderate to high. Several independent sources including registry information, Look@LAN configuration, browser history, webmail artefacts, IRC records and NNTP settings associate the Mr. Evil profile with the name Greg Schardt. No single artefact proves attribution on its own, but the consistency across separate applications provides substantial corroboration.

Alternative explanations were considered. The RegisteredOwner value is entered during Windows installation and could have been supplied by another person with access to the computer. Likewise, the registered owner and the person who normally used the machine could have been different. The Mr. Evil account also shows a password-reset event and does not require a strong password according to the SAM flags. These possibilities cannot be completely excluded, although the available evidence does not provide strong support for them.

5. Hacking Capability & Usage Evidence

Tool	Category	Installed ?	Configured?	Executed (evidence)	Legitimate Use	Potential Misuse
Ethereal 0.10.6	Packet sniffer	Yes	Default	Yes produced the "interception" pcap file on Mr. Evil's profile (strongest use evidence)	Network troubleshooting	Traffic interception / credential theft
WinPcap 3.01 alpha	Packet capture driver	Yes	N/A (library)	Inferred required by / supports Ethereal's capture	Enables any packet-capture app	Same as above
Network Stumbler 0.4.0	WiFi/WLAN scanner	Yes (remove only)		Not independently confirmed	Site survey / WLAN auditing	Wardriving / unauthorized AP discovery

Cain & Abel v2.5 beta45	Password cracker + sniffer	Yes		Abel.dll present under Program Files/Cain install confirmed by AV signature hit	Password recovery / pen-testing	Credential theft, ARP poisoning
123 Write All Stored Passwords	Password cracker	Yes		Not independently confirmed	Recovering own forgotten passwords	Extracting others' stored credentials
Anonymizer Bar 2.0	Anonymizing proxy toolbar	Yes (remove only)		Not independently confirmed	Privacy protection	Concealing identity while attacking / intercepting
CuteFTP	FTP client	Yes		Not independently confirmed	Legitimate file transfer	Exfiltrating captured/cracked data

Where execution is described as not confirmed, the finding should be treated as an installation finding rather than proof of use. Prefetch records and application-specific logs can provide additional evidence of execution. The reference examination provides a confirmed Prefetch example for mIRC.

5.1 Communications Artefacts

Artefact Type	Finding	Investigative Relevance
NNTP / news server settings	Forte Agent: NewsServer=news.dallas.sbcglobal.net, MailServer=smtp.sbcglobal.net, EMailAddress=whoknowsme@sbcglobal.net (independently corroborated inside Outlook Express .dbx files)	Identifies ISP-provided news/mail identity used by Mr. Evil
Newsgroups subscribed	alt.2600.cardz/.codez/.crackz/.hackerz/.moderated/.phreakz/.programz; alt.binaries.hacking.beginner/.computers/.utilities/.websites; alt.dss.hack; alt.hacking; alt.nl.binaries.hack; alt.stupidity.hackers.malicious; multiple free.binaries.hacking.* groups	Direct interest in hacking/cracking communities
Outlook Express artefacts	Identity folder under Mr. Evil profile containing the above .dbx newsgroup archives plus Inbox/Outbox/Sent/Deleted Items	Confirms OE was configured and used under this profile
Forte Agent artefacts	Installed under Program Files/Agent; AGENT.INI holds identity + server config	Second, independent NNTP client corroborating the same identity

mIRC channels / logs	#Chataholics, #CyberCafe, #Elite.Hackers, #evilfork, #funny, #houston, #ISO-WAREZ, #LuxShell, #mp3xserv, #thedarktower, #ushells (UnderNet/EFnet/AfterNET logs); mirc.ini userid=Mrevil	Real-time chat with hacking-themed channel names; logging was enabled, indicating retained chat history
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6. Captured Traffic & Communications Reconstruction

Property	Value
File identified as interception evidence	Documents and Settings\Mr. Evil\interception
File format (validated via `file`)	libpcap capture file, microsecond timestamps, little-endian, version 2.4, Ethernet, capture/snap length 65535
SHA-256 of extracted copy	
Capture duration	To be calculated from the working copy
Protocols observed	HTTP confirmed (analysed below); run `tshark -q -z io,phs` for full protocol hierarchy
Number of distinct endpoints / conversations	To be calculated from the working copy

6.1 HTTP Host / User-Agent Analysis

Host	User-Agent	Inference
mobile.msn.com	Mozilla/4.0 (compatible; MSIE 4.01; Windows CE; PPC; 240x320)	Mobile MSN portal access from a Pocket PC
login.passport.com	Mozilla/4.0 (compatible; MSIE 4.01; Windows CE; PPC; 240x320)	Microsoft Passport (login credential) traffic

login.passport.net	Mozilla/4.0 (compatible; MSIE 4.01; Windows CE; PPC; 240x320)	Microsoft Passport (login credential) traffic
www.passportimages.com	Mozilla/4.0 (compatible; MSIE 4.01; Windows CE; PPC; 240x320)	Supporting assets for the Passport login flow

The requests in the capture use the same distinctive User-Agent string, identifying a Windows CE Pocket PC device with a 240x320 display. This indicates that the captured traffic came from a PDA/Pocket PC accessing Microsoft Passport login pages. The finding is consistent with the allegation that wireless traffic from a nearby device was intercepted rather than the traffic originating from the examined laptop itself.

6.2 Webmail / SMTP Identity

The address mrevilrulez@yahoo.com occurred 12 times in the Mr. Evil profile, making it the most frequently recovered webmail address.

Cached Yahoo Mail pages located under Local Settings\Temporary Internet Files\Content.IE5\...\ShowLetter[1].htm include a message addressed to mrevilrulez@yahoo.com. These cached pages provide additional evidence that the account was configured and used within the Mr. Evil profile.

7. Deleted Files, Recycle Bin & Malware Examination

7.1 Recycle Bin (INFO2) Findings

Recycle Bin path: RECYCLER\S-1-5-21-2000478354-688789844-1708537768-1003 (Mr. Evil's SID)

Original Path	Deletion Time (UTC)	Size (bytes)	Permanently Removed?
...\Mr. Evil\Desktop\lalsetup250.exe (Look@LAN installer)	2004-08-25 16:18:25	2,160,128	No
...\Mr. Evil\Desktop\netstumblerinstaller_0_4_0.exe	2004-08-27 15:12:30	1,325,056	No

...\\Mr. Evil\\Desktop\\WinPcap_3_01_a.exe	2004-08-27 15:15:26	442,880	No
...\\Mr. Evil\\Desktop\\ethereal-setup-0.10.6.exe	2004-08-27 15:29:58	8,460,800	No

7.2 Recycle Bin vs. File-System Deleted Count

Metric	Count
Executable installers in Recycle Bin (INFO2)	4 (plus desktop.ini and INFO2 itself = 6 total entries in the folder)
Total deleted entries, file-system wide (fls -rFd)	365

The Recycle Bin/INFO2 records only files deleted through the normal Windows Recycle Bin process. Four hacking-tool installers were found there. The wider file-system count of 365 deleted entries includes browser cache files, temporary files, application data and other deleted MFT entries, including files removed without using the Recycle Bin. The short interval between installation and deletion of several installers is notable and is consistent with an install-and-clean-up pattern.

7.3 Malware / Antivirus Scan

Property	Value
Engine / version	ClamAV (clamscan) 0.103.0
Signature database	8,559,038 known signatures
Signature database date	Not recorded in the source examination
Directories / files scanned	766 directories / 11,305 files (1,983.00 MB scanned)
Infected / flagged files	22
Scan duration	1,512.949 sec (≈25 min 12 sec)

Most of the 22 flagged files were identified by ClamAV signatures associated with hacking or penetration-testing utilities located in the My Documents\ENUMERATION, EXPLOITATION and FOOTPRINTING folders. Examples include enum.exe, SAMDUMP.EXE, Brutus, GetAdmin.exe, lsadump2, NetBus, sechole and superscan, as well as Cain & Abel's Abel.dll. A separate finding concerns WINDOWS\system32\ahui.exe and its dllcache copy, which were flagged as Win.Virus.Virut-6804272-

0. This finding is treated separately because it represents a virus signature rather than a generic hacking-tool classification.

The ClamAV results should be interpreted with care. Signature-based scanning cannot identify every unknown or obfuscated threat, and many of the 22 detections are category-based matches for legitimate security or penetration-testing tools. These detections should not be treated as proof of malicious behaviour. The ahui.exe finding is the distinct virus related result identified in the scan.

No recovered or flagged executable was executed as part of this examination.

8. Integrated Timeline & Final Forensic Opinion

8.1 UTC Timeline

Timestamp (UTC)	Source Artefact	Event Description	Category
2004-08-19 16:59:24	SAM	Administrator / Guest accounts created (OS install defaults)	Account
2004-08-19 17:07:19	SOFTWARE\NetworkCards	Xircom CardBus Ethernet 100 + Modem 56 registered	Hardware
2004-08-19 22:28:24 / 22:35:19	SAM	HelpAssistant / SUPPORT_388945a0 accounts created	Account
2004-08-19 22:48:27	SOFTWARE\CurrentVersion	Windows XP installed	System
2004-08-19 23:03:54	SAM	"Mr. Evil" account created	Account
2004-08-20 15:05–15:56	SOFTWARE\Uninstall	Cain & Abel, Anonymizer Bar, 123 Write All Stored Passwords, Forte Agent, CuteFTP, Look@LAN 2.50 installed	Tool install
2004-08-25 16:18:25	Recycle Bin / INFO2	Look@LAN installer (lalsetup250.exe) deleted	Cleanup
2004-08-27 15:08:23	SAM (last login)	"Mr. Evil" last logged on	Account

2004-08-27 15:12–15:29	SOFTWARE\Uninstall	Network Stumbler, WinPcap, Ethereal installed	Tool install
2004-08-27 15:12:30– 15:29:58	Recycle Bin / INFO2	NetStumbler, WinPcap, Ethereal installers deleted (each within minutes of install)	Cleanup
2004-08-27 15:31:44	SOFTWARE\NetworkCards	Compaq WL110 Wireless LAN card registered	Hardware
2004-08-27 15:46:23 / 15:46:33	ProfileList / SYSTEM\Shutdown	Mr. Evil profile unloaded; last recorded system shutdown	System

The timestamps for the interception capture were not extracted during this examination. The capture start and end times should be obtained from the pcap so that the traffic can be accurately placed within the overall timeline.

8.2 Evidence Matrix

Category	Key Findings	Source Section
Attribution	Registry owner, Look@LAN self-ID, Yahoo id_check URL, webmail address, and IRC/NNTP identity all converge on Greg Schardt = Mr. Evil	Section: 4
Capability	6+ dual-use network/security tools installed: Ethereal, WinPcap, Network Stumbler, Cain & Abel, Anonymizer Bar, 123 Write All Stored Passwords, CuteFTP	Section: 5
Actual Use	Ethereal use directly evidenced by the generated "interception" pcap file; other tools' execution not independently confirmed in this pass	Section: 5
Generated / Intercepted Data	"interception" pcap contains HTTP traffic from a Windows CE/Pocket PC device to Microsoft Passport login pages	Section: 6

Communications	NNTP identity (whoknowsme@sbcglobal.net), hacking-themed newsgroup subscriptions, mIRC channels with hacking-themed names, webmail mrevilrulez@yahoo.com	Section: 5.1 / 6
Deletion / Cleanup Behaviour	4 hacking-tool installers deleted to Recycle Bin within minutes of installation on two separate dates, suggesting deliberate cleanup	Section: 7

8.3 Central Question & Conclusion

The central question is whether the evidence supports the conclusion that the computer was operated by Greg Schardt under the alias Mr. Evil and whether it was used for hacking related activity.

The evidence strongly supports the conclusion that the computer was registered to and regularly used by an individual identifying as Greg Schardt and Mr. Evil. This assessment is based on consistent artefacts from the Windows registry, Look@LAN configuration, browser history, webmail records and communications applications. The evidence also shows that network interception capability was used the recovered interception file is a valid packet capture containing third party HTTP traffic associated with Microsoft Passport login pages. However, the available evidence does not establish beyond doubt that Greg Schardt was physically at the keyboard at the exact time the captured traffic was collected. The attribution evidence identifies the account and profile, but it is not equivalent to direct proof of the person operating the computer at that moment.

8.4 Limitations of This Examination

1. ClamAV is a signature-based scanner and cannot rule out unknown or obfuscated threats. Most detections in this examination were associated with hacking or penetration-testing utilities rather than confirmed malicious activity. The ahui.exe Win.Virus.Virut finding is the distinct virus-related detection.
2. The attribution evidence links the Windows account and profile to the identified names, but it does not by itself establish who was physically operating the computer at a particular time, including during the packet-capture period.
3. The packet capture represents only the period covered by the file and does not provide a record of the computer's complete network activity. The capture start and end times should therefore be extracted and documented.

4. Execution was not independently confirmed for several installed applications, including Network Stumbler, 123 Write All Stored Passwords, Anonymizer Bar and CuteFTP. These findings should currently be described as installation evidence. Prefetch and application-log analysis would be required to establish execution.
5. SCHARDT.006 and SCHARDT.007 have the same MD5 hash. The anomaly should be independently verified against the downloaded evidence and documented in the final integrity assessment.